

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1988-09-30

To all National Spiritual Assemblies dear bahá'í friends

1 we enclose a copy of a new compilation entitled A Chaste and Holy Life,
2 which was prepared by the research department at the request of the uni-
3 versal house of justice.

4 56-1

5 given the rapidly declining moral standards in the world, the house of
6 justice has instructed us to emphasize that it considers it both necessary and
7 timely for the bahá'í friends to increase their understanding of and adher-
8 ence to the standard of a chaste and holy life that is upheld in our Teachings. To this
end, the house of justice urges the National Spiritual Assemblies to

9 56-1. The compilation is too lengthy to include here; see cc 1:45-64.55.12

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57 1986-1992 • The Six Year Plan

58 99make the compilation available to the friends on the widest possible scale,
59 having it translated, as necessary, in whole or in part, into the major lan-
60 guages of the country. it is also important that the friends be encouraged to
61 study the implications set forth in these extracts, and to endeavor strenu-
62 ously to exemplify these noble standards in their personal lives.

As the range of activities and projects in which the bahá'í community

63 engages necessarily continues to expand and diversify, the house of justice
64 believes it is vital that the moral and ethical teachings of our faith be neither

65 overlooked nor mistakenly regarded as being of less importance than our social,
administrative and metaphysical teachings. indeed, Shoghi effendi,

66 in a letter written on his behalf, stressed the need for such balance and for according
appropriate weight to the moral principles of the faith.

Too much emphasis is often laid on the social and economic aspects of

67 the Teachings; but the moral aspect cannot be overemphasized.

68 in the current climate of social and moral decline, at a time when, in

69 the world at large, moral decay, hypocrisy and compromise are endemic, and words, unsupported by actions, have lost their value, the believers are

challenged to become “b ahá’ís in character as well as in belief,”

70 56-2 to strive

71 determinedly to exemplify the bahá’í standard, to become distinguished for

72 their moral excellence, and, by the quality of their individual lives and the

73 nature of their bahá’í community life, to demonstrate the vitalizing power

74 of the cause not only to bring peace, security and true spiritual happiness

75 to the individual heart, but to transform society as well. Shoghi effendi

76 repeatedly emphasized the importance of the force of example. A letter writ-ten on his behalf states:

77 his constant hope is that the believers will conduct themselves,

individually and in their bahá’í community life, in such a manner as

78 to attract the attention of others to the cause. The world is not only

79 starving for lofty principles and ideals, it is, above all, starving for a

80 shining example which the b ahá’ís can and must provide.

81 56-3

82 with loving b ahá’í greetings,

Department of tHe secretariat

83 56-2. cc 2:13.

84 56-3. cc 1:382.56.3

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57 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

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Remarkable Numbers of New Enrollments

13 o c t o b e r 1988

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

14 rejoice eve worldwide celebrATioNS ANNiverSArY bir Th bleSSed báB evi-
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Universal HoUse of JUstice

19 58

Success of Collaboration with Network on

Conservation and Religion

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]